

September 18th, 2026
Week 38
Volume 282, Issue 1253

QUOTE
of the
WEEK

"Plans are worthless, but planning is everything."

- Dwight D. Eisenhower

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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FREIGHT PAYS, BEACHES WAIT

Last week the risk spread west. This week the two chokepoints stopped taking turns. Saudi Arabia and the Houthis exchanged fresh strikes as fighting around Yemen's Red Sea coast continued, while Iran's Revolutionary Guards said they struck and detained a Togo-flagged tanker attempting what Tehran called an unauthorised passage through Hormuz. Traffic remains the cleaner commercial measure. Only four commodity vessels were recorded transiting Hormuz on Thursday against a recent ten-day average of about sixteen, while Bab al-Mandab handled twenty-three against an average nearer twenty-six. Passage remains possible. Predictability does not.

Crude finally blinked after last week's surge. Brent slipped toward USD 103 per barrel on Friday and WTI toward USD 101 as additional Saudi cargoes moving through Oman and expectations of partial restoration of the East-West pipeline eased immediate supply fears. Brent was heading for its first weekly loss in three. That is relief, not normalisation. Triple-digit crude, disrupted routing and elevated insurance costs still leave the trading environment sufficiently expensive to support freight rather than release ageing tonnage.

Freight eased from last week's extremes, but the recycling message barely changed. The Baltic Dry Index closed Thursday at 3,336, down from 3,521 a week earlier, with Capesizes at 5,656, Panamaxs at 2,282 and Supramaxes at 1,762. Capesize earnings remained close to USD 48,000 per day, while the geared sectors continued to show firmness in several Atlantic regions. Owners of ageing ships still have something worth doing with them. The beaches continue to compete against daily earnings and second-hand alternatives, and candidate supply is paying the price.

The macro week added another layer. The Federal Reserve raised its target range by 25 basis points to 3.75% to 4.00%, while India's August CPI accelerated to 4.82% from 4.45%. The Indian Rupee finished around the 95.9 area against the Dollar, Pakistan's Rupee strengthened to approximately 277.25, Bangladesh's latest official spot reference moved back toward 123.0 and the Turkish Lira weakened toward 48.8. There is no clean currency windfall across the basin: Pakistan remains orderly, Bangladesh stable, India has lost its early-September advantage and Turkey continues to surrender Dollar purchasing power.

At the beaches, physical activity continues to tell a more active story than the fresh sales list. Previously secured ships are arriving and delivering across Alang, Chattogram and Gadani, yet no fresh sub-continent market sales were reported this week. Pakistan remains best placed, Bangladesh has demand returning but not yet at numbers capable of consistently beating its neighbour, and India continues to extract its better business from specialist and non-ferrous-rich tonnage. The waterfront is moving. The candidate list is not.

The week's most relevant recycling-specific regulatory development came from Europe. BIMCO, CLIA, ECSA, ICS, INTERCARGO, INTERFERRY, INTERTANKO and the World Shipping Council jointly called on EU Member States to support the European Commission proposal to add two Indian recycling facilities to the European List. The decision remains pending, but the breadth of industry backing reinforces the structural compliance story that has been building around Alang this year.

Pakistan therefore enters another week at the head of the sub-continent, Bangladesh has hunger without the competitive edge to convert every opportunity, and India continues to operate a second market outside the standard pricing board. Turkey has awakened modestly from the summer lull. Above all of them sits the same constraint: owners are still being paid to trade rather than recycle. The bids are waiting. The hulls are busy elsewhere.

Highlights:

- Routes tighten.

- Crude retreats.

- Earnings win.

- Sales vanish.

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BANGLADESH



HUNGER WITHOUT EDGE

Demand returns.

Last week Chattogram's returning appetite finally found something to buy, with the UNIORDER confirming that a workable smaller dry unit could still locate an end buyer. This week the appetite remains, but the transaction list has gone quiet again. Demand is clearly emerging after the softer period, yet the problem is now comparative rather than absolute. Where the very slim selection of candidates can command stronger competition, Pakistan remains better placed. Chattogram has buyers. It does not yet have the winning bid often enough.

Waterfront moves.

The waterfront is considerably busier. The 5,602 LDT bulker Dina Ocean, carried as an arrival last week, is now recorded as delivered on September 14, while the 1,961 LDT tanker Leo Star was delivered September 11. Four subsequent arrivals have replenished the anchorage: the 16,708 LDT tanker Forever on September 15, followed on September 17 by the 5,733 LDT bulker Ganga Hai 666 and reefers NEPT, 3,060 LDT, and Xiang Rui, 1,304 LDT. Physical waterfront activity has therefore improved materially, but these movements should not be confused with fresh recycling sales.

Steel flat.

Local steel provided no help in closing the competitive gap. Chattogram plate remained unchanged throughout the week at BDT 64,000 per ton, approximately USD 522.24 per ton. Bangladesh Bank's latest spot reference moved back toward BDT 123.0 to the Dollar, while August inflation remains at 8.26%, marginally below July's 8.32%. The currency is orderly and steel is flat. Neither is generating the extra purchasing power required to chase Pakistan.

Bangladesh therefore looks healthier operationally than the absence of fresh deals suggests. Plots are receiving tonnage, demand has returned and the post-monsoon rhythm is firmly back. The missing ingredient is competitive pricing against a Pakistani market that remains better positioned whenever a suitable hull actually appears. Chattogram has recovered its hunger. The number still needs work.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA



SPECIALISTS WITHOUT RIVALS

Alang continues to operate two markets at once. On conventional bulkers and tankers, even though remarkably few are available, India remains well behind Pakistan and Bangladesh. On specialist, non-ferrous-rich and compliance-sensitive tonnage, the story is entirely different. Reefers, passenger vessels, tankers with higher non-ferrous content and other specialist candidates continue to generate considerably stronger enquiry and keep Indian recyclers active despite the conventional pricing gap.

Specialists lead.

That distinction received another structural boost this week. Eight major international shipping associations jointly urged EU Member States to approve the European Commission proposal to include two Indian recycling facilities on the European List, arguing that inclusion should follow objective assessment against EU safety and environmental requirements. This remains a proposal, not a completed listing, but the pressure behind it has widened considerably.

Backing grows.

The port report advances last week's specialist story neatly. Mandarin Arrow, carried last week as an arrival, is now recorded as delivered on September 12. The sizeable 22,657 LDT oil tanker James was delivered September 16, while the 6,520 LDT reefer Frio Hellenic arrived September 12 and the 8,110 LDT bulker Novaya Zemlya arrived September 16. Alang is therefore anything but inactive. The composition of its business simply continues to matter more than the headline board. Steel was less helpful. Plate opened at INR 42,600 per ton and eased modestly to INR 42,500, closing there on Friday. The supplied USD equivalent moved from approximately USD 445.84 to USD 443.77 per ton. The Rupee finished around 95.9 against the Dollar, while August CPI rose to 4.82% from 4.45%, removing some of the cleaner macro support Alang enjoyed earlier this month.

Standard gap.

India consequently remains third on standard units, and there is little reason to disguise that gap. Yet conventional pricing alone still understates activity in Alang. Specialist tonnage is moving, compliance infrastructure is attracting wider industry support and the waterfront continues to receive meaningful ships. One board, two markets. Alang continues to make the second one count.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN



LEAD WITHOUT SUPPLY

Market leads.

Gadani remains the best placed sub-continent destination for another week, although this time there was nothing fresh to prove it against. No new market sale was reported, not because Pakistani demand has disappeared, but because the candidate pool remains painfully thin while freight earnings continue to outperform recycling economics. The distinction matters. Pakistan has moved beyond August's indiscriminate urgency, but attractive vessels can still find the basin's strongest conventional competition when they actually appear.

Hulls arrive.

The waterfront confirms that recyclers are no longer staring at an empty beach. The 2,449 LDT bulker Spring was delivered September 16, while BR Glory, 5,000 LDT, and the 2,632 LDT general cargo vessel Larus were delivered September 13. The week's principal fresh arrival was the 11,060 LDT tanker Yue on September 16. Maria and Lina F remain recorded as earlier arrivals. Previously secured tonnage is therefore feeding Gadani even while the next sales cycle remains stubbornly absent.

Steel slips.

Local steel finally moved, and in the wrong direction. Pakistan plate opened the period at PKR 200,000 per ton before dropping to PKR 195,000 and remaining there through Friday. The supplied USD equivalent fell from USD 719.94 per ton to approximately USD 695.05 per ton. The Rupee itself strengthened slightly, with the State Bank's September 18 M2M rate at PKR 277.2522 to the Dollar, while the policy rate remains 11.5%. SBP reserves also increased sharply to USD 21.389 billion as of September 11. The local macro picture has therefore not deteriorated with steel. The plate correction is the more relevant immediate signal for recyclers.

Pakistan consequently sits in a familiar but more balanced position. The extreme pent-up demand of August has been partly satisfied and softer steel gives second-tier buyers another reason not to chase indiscriminately. Yet candidate scarcity prevents that normalisation from becoming genuine weakness. Gadani still has appetite and still has the lead. What it does not have is enough ships to test either properly.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY



RATE HOLDS, BOARD LIFTS

September has brought the modest seasonal improvement Aliaga traditionally sees once the summer period closes. Recyclers are showing more appetite for fresh tonnage and the GMS desk board has moved accordingly, particularly at the dry and container ends. This is a recovery within Turkey's own market rather than any attempt to challenge South Asian pricing.

Appetite returns.

The macro backdrop remains less accommodating. August CPI stands at 31.51%, while the TCMB kept its policy rate at 37% and reiterated this week that elevated energy prices remain an upside inflation risk. The Lira has meanwhile weakened toward TRY 48.8 to the Dollar, another fresh low and an ongoing constraint on Dollar-denominated purchasing power.

Lira weakens.

Aliaga therefore remains dependent on geography, specialist units, European regulatory access and Basel-compliant trades rather than conventional competition with the sub-continent. The improving appetite is genuine, but it is seasonal and selective. Summer has ended. The hierarchy has not.

Niche holds.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 38 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Pakistan	Steady	500 / LDT	525 / LDT	535 / LDT
2	Bangladesh	Steady	490 / LDT	515 / LDT	525 / LDT
3	India	Improving	465 / LDT	485 / LDT	495 / LDT
4	Turkey	Improving	300 / LDT	310-315 / LDT	325-330 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- 276 million cubic yards of landfill space estimated to have been saved through ship recycling at Alang is greater than the roughly 268 million cubic yards **excavated to build the Panama Canal**.
- 124.5 million barrels of oil estimated to have been saved through ship recycling at Alang is enough to fill approximately **62 fully laden VLCCs**.
- 69.16 million tonnes of steel recovered through ship recycling at Alang is equivalent to almost **five months of India's entire current crude-steel production**.

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
October 02 - Mahatma Gandhi's Birthday	September 25 – October 03 October 08 – October 15

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
20–21 October 2026 – Durga Puja	September 26 – September 29 October 09 – October 12

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	TURKEY
November 09 – Allama Iqbal Day	28–29 October 2026 – Republic Day

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ALANG - Port Position as of September 18, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	James	22,657	Oil Tanker	<i>Delivered September 16</i>
2	Novaya Zemlya	8,110	Bulk Carrier	Arrived September 16
3	Mandarin Arrow	14,825	General Cargo	<i>Delivered September 12</i>
4	Frio Hellenic	6,520	Reefer	Arrived September 12

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of September 18, 2026

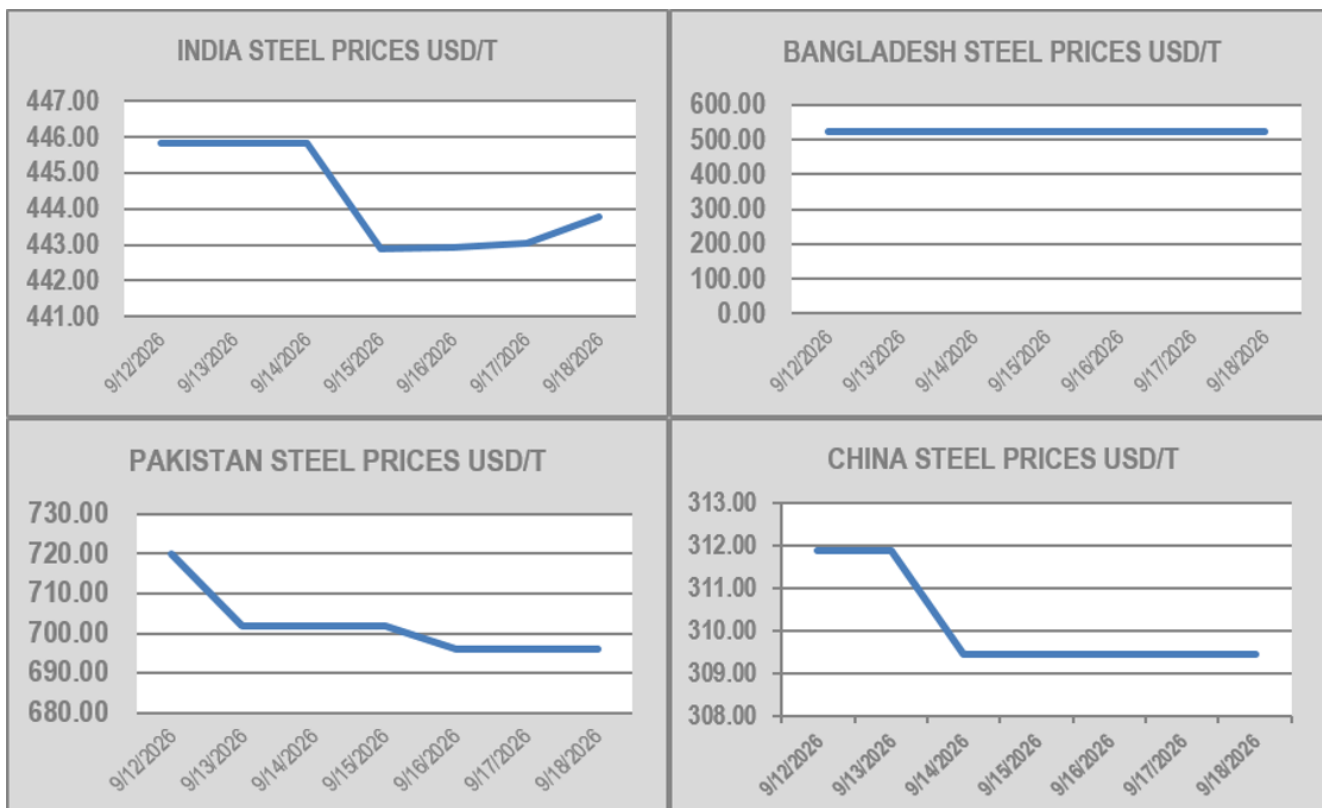
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Xiang Rui	1,304	Refrigerated Cargo	Arrived September 17
2	NEPT	3,060	Refrigerated Cargo	Arrived September 17
3	Ganga Hai 666	5,733	Bulk Carrier	Arrived September 17
4	Forever	16,708	Tanker	Arrived September 15
5	Dina Ocean	5,602	Bulk Carrier	<i>Delivered September 14</i>
6	Leo Star	1,961	Tanker	<i>Delivered September 11</i>

GADANI - Port Position as of September 18, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Yue	11,060	Tanker	Arrived September 16
2	Spring	2,449	Bulk Carrier	<i>Delivered September 16</i>
3	BR Glory	5,000	Bulk Carrier	<i>Delivered September 13</i>
4	Larus	2,632	General Cargo	<i>Delivered September 13</i>
5	Maria	6,141	Bulk Carrier	Arrived September 09
6	Lina F	5,688	Bulk Carrier	Arrived September 01

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DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
9/12/2026	445.84	42,600.00	719.94	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	311.91
9/13/2026	445.84	42,600.00	701.94	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	311.91
9/14/2026	445.84	42,600.00	701.94	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
9/15/2026	442.89	42,500.00	701.94	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
9/16/2026	442.94	42,500.00	696.06	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
9/17/2026	443.03	42,500.00	696.06	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
9/18/2026	443.77	42,500.00	696.06	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46


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